Norway May Still Get to Play at the World Juniors

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Norway's young hockey players might still play at the world junior **championships** after all. The Norwegian Ice Hockey Association said on Sunday that Norway is being moved out of the **tournament** so Russia can take part instead. The change follows a **ruling** by the Court of Arbitration for Sport, which let Russian teams return to international play. The **tournament** for the best male players under 20 starts on December 26 in Alberta, Canada. But the hockey **federation** has not formally announced the change, and its website still lists Norway. Norway, ranked tenth, would drop to the 1A Division. Russia may not get to play either: Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has said he will not let the Russian team enter Canada, which could open the door for Norway again. "The situation is still unclear," said Peter Salsten, Norway's ice hockey secretary general. Six nations, including Norway, have promised not to play Russia while the war in Ukraine goes on. Some **sponsors** have also said they will pull out if Russia plays. Russia has not played in the **tournament** since 2021.

Word Treasure

tournament -- A contest where teams play a series of games to find a winner.
championships -- Big contests to decide who is the best in a sport.
sponsors -- Companies that pay money to support an event.
federation -- A group that runs and makes the rules for a sport.
ruling -- A decision made by a court or a judge.

Background you need

The world junior championships are a big hockey contest for the best young players from different countries.

Russian teams were kept out of the contest after Russia invaded Ukraine.

Now a sports court has let them back in, and Canada can still decide which teams may enter the country.

Break it down

WHO: Norway's young hockey players, Russia, and Canada's prime minister.
WHAT: Norway may lose its place at the world junior championships so Russia can play.
WHERE: The tournament is in Alberta, Canada.
WHY: A sports court let Russian teams return, but Canada may still keep them out.

Why it matters

If you play a team sport, this story shows how rules and fair play matter even for the best young players in the world.

Test what you remember

1. Why might Norway lose its place at the world juniors?

- (A) Because Norway lost a game
- (B) So Russia can take part instead
- (C) Because the contest was cancelled
- (D) Because Norway has no team

2. When does the tournament start?

- (A) December 26
- (B) February 2022
- (C) January 10
- (D) November 9

3. What did Canada's prime minister say?

- (A) He will move the contest to Norway
- (B) He will pay for Norway's trip
- (C) He will end the war
- (D) He will not let the Russian team enter Canada

4. How many nations have promised not to play Russia?

- (A) Ten
- (B) Four
- (C) Six
- (D) Two

5. What will happen to Norway?

- (A) It would drop to the 1A Division
- (B) It would win the contest
- (C) It would join Russia's team
- (D) It would stop playing hockey

6. When did Russia last play in the tournament?

- (A) 2022
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2020
- (D) 2021

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: D 4: C 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Norway's ice hockey secretary general, Peter Salsten: He says the situation is still unclear and hopes the last word has not been said about Norway playing in Canada.

2. The six nations: They have promised not to play Russia while the war in Ukraine goes on.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):